

Grants & Resources for Female Entrepreneurs

Women-owned businesses have a growing set of grants, lenders, and support networks built just for them. Below are trusted national resources. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Many of these are free to apply for and recurring — so if you miss one round, another opens soon. Getting certified as women-owned can also unlock contracts. Watch for fee-charging “grant” scams.

1 Grants for Women

Recurring grant programs specifically for women entrepreneurs.

- ☐ **Amber Grant**
Monthly \$10,000 grants plus larger year-end awards for women.
→ ambergrantsforwomen.com
- ☐ **IFundWomen**
Grants, crowdfunding, and coaching for women-owned businesses.
→ ifundwomen.com
- ☐ **Cartier Women's Initiative**
Major awards for women-led, impact-driven businesses.
→ www.cartierwomensinitiative.com

2 Free Help & Training

SBA-funded centers focused on women entrepreneurs.

- ☐ **Women's Business Centers**
Free training, counseling, and capital access for women.
→ www.sba.gov/local-assistance/resource-partners/womens-business-centers
- ☐ **SBA Office of Women's Business Ownership**
Federal hub for women's business resources and contracts.
→ www.sba.gov/about-sba/sba-locations/headquarters-offices/office-womens-business-ownership

3 Certification for Contracts

Certify as women-owned to access set-aside contracts.

- ☐ **Women-Owned Small Business (WOSB) Certification**
Free federal certification to compete for set-aside contracts.
→ www.sba.gov/federal-contracting/contracting-assistance-programs/women-owned-small-business-federal-contract-program

4 Funding & Community

Lenders and networks that back women founders.

☐ Kiva — 0% Microloans

0% loans up to \$15,000, popular with women founders.

→ www.kiva.org/borrow

☐ Hello Alice

Grants, funding, and a community for women and underrepresented founders.

→ helloalice.com

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Apply directly on each official site — never pay a “grant service” to enter you. Legitimate women’s grants are free to apply for, even if some (like Amber Grant) have a small entry fee clearly stated up front.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Set a monthly reminder to apply for recurring grants like Amber Grant. Persistence pays — many winners applied several times before getting funded.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national resources. For women’s business grants and centers near you, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
